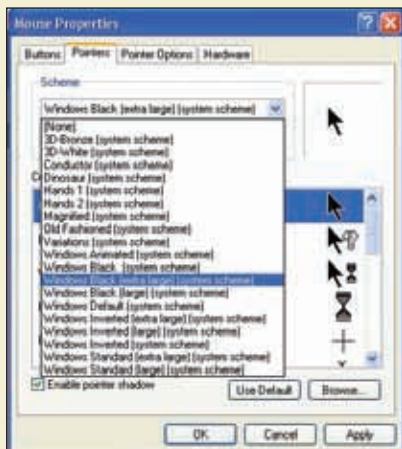




SETTING UP A PC FOR YOUR PARENTS

Our parents, old and wise they may be, but they are usually befuddled by the simplest of tasks relating to a computer. Being Digitians, we have the knowledge to ease our parents' burden when it comes to the computer. The main aim of this process is to ensure that your parents' interaction with the computer be kept at a bare minimum. In fact, follow the "Palm" philosophy and try and ensure that they can get to what they want within 3 clicks of the mouse.



High visibility cursors will ensure that your parents know exactly where to point

Rename shortcuts

Start off by creating a folder on the desktop. Give it a name that your parents would remember, even something like Windows' own "Click here to Start" should be enough. Make sure that the folder icon you use is clear and prominent, say a bright colour or a very large size.

Now, put into that folder shortcuts for every single programs you think your parents might need to use, or you might want them to use, as you try to assist them from the other end of the world.

Rename all the programs to something relevant. For example, rename Google Chrome to "Internet Explorer", or say, OpenOffice Writer to

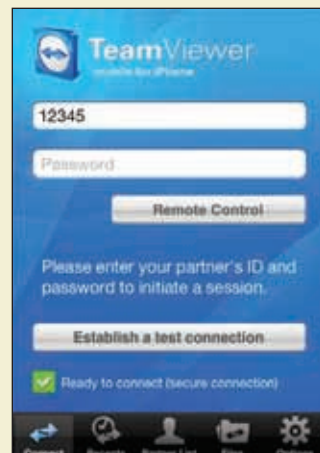
"Word". In fact, Windows supports very large file names, feel free to add a full description of what the program does if you so feel like it. You can rename programs like Skype to "Click to chat with your kids!" or something similar. You can even try renaming programs like Outlook Express or Mozilla Thunderbird to "Check your email" and so on.

Automate tasks

Download and install all programs that are required for the smooth running of your PC. Essentials include a good defragmenter, anti-virus and anti-spyware software. Make sure that all these programs are set to update automatically at regular intervals. It's also best to set these programs to perform their tasks autonomously in the background. If they have an option where they can be set to run while the screensaver is running, enable it.

Access the internet

Another area where parents notoriously struggle. First and foremost, try to setup auto login for your Internet connection if required. Setting up PPPoE in the modem or router beforehand will also help. As



You can assist via your smart phone as well



The Ubuntu desktop, master it and it will be your friend

mentioned earlier, rename your favourite browser to "Internet Explorer". Setting up Speed Dial is something that you must do. As with the essential programs folder, the speed dial should house all the web sites that your parents would need to visit. Attach labels according to the usage rather than the web site name. Another thing you can do is to ensure that autologin is enabled on all the web sites your parents will need to login to and that the usernames and passwords for those web sites are stored before hand.

Ease accessibility

Enlarge the pointer using the pointer options found within your OS. It's best if you specifically choose the high visibility, enlarged, black pointers. Do the same for the icons as well. If you're using Windows 7, configure the libraries well and make sure your parents know how to access them.

Enable "Ctrl to highlight pointer" in the mouse options in the Windows Control panel. This is a very useful feature as your parents, most probably, will spend a lot of time hunting for the mouse. In Ubuntu, you can enable the "eyes" in the classic gnome taskbar. Perfect for keeping an eye (2 in this case), on the mouse at all times.

Install TeamViewer or any such remote access software so that you can have control

of your parents' PC from anywhere. The advantage of a software like TeamViewer is that you can not only use it from any PC, you can also remotely control another PC (your parent's PC) via an iOS or Android device as well.



Setting up PPPoE in Ubuntu is a breeze

Set them up with Ubuntu

This might seem counter-intuitive as not many students themselves are comfortable with using Linux, so how will your parents deal with it?

The main thing here is that using Ubuntu would, arguably, be easier for your parents to use, especially if they don't have any Windows specific app that they need to run. The OS is secure compared to Windows, your parents can plug in pen drives and not worry about viruses, messing with any major setting, even installing applications will require an administrator password, PPPoE is easily configured in Linux. Installation of